

Elimination Guide

Sensitivity quiz, food-symptom diary, single-food elimination and reintroduction, and your doctor conversation · Module 2, Training 6

Read this first

- **Get tested for celiac disease before removing gluten.** The blood test (tTG-IgA) detects antibodies your body makes only while you eat gluten; going gluten-free first can make the result falsely normal (NIH; Celiac Disease Foundation). Undiagnosed celiac is more common in unexplained infertility and recurrent pregnancy loss (Tersigni et al., *Human Reproduction Update*).
- **Don't cut dairy for fertility alone.** Full-fat dairy was linked to *lower* anovulatory infertility risk (Chavarro et al., *Human Reproduction*). Cut it only if it makes you unwell, and ask your doctor if you have any allergy history.
- **IgG "food sensitivity panels" are not validated** (American Academy of Allergy, Asthma & Immunology and counterparts). A diary and a structured elimination are the tools that work.
- **History of disordered eating?** Do this only with a professional, or skip elimination and focus on adding. Nothing in this course is worth waking old patterns.
- Never remove whole food groups long-term without a registered dietitian or doctor involved, especially before conception.

Part 1 · Sensitivity quiz (40 XP)

For the last month: 0 = never · 1 = sometimes · 2 = often · 3 = most days

#	SYMPTOM	0	1	2	3
1	Bloating, cramping or gas within 2–3 hours of eating	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	Diarrhoea, constipation or alternating	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	Reflux or nausea after certain meals	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	Fatigue or brain fog after eating	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	Headaches or migraines that seem food-linked	☐	☐	☐	☐
6	Skin: eczema, hives, itching, acne flares	☐	☐	☐	☐
7	Mouth ulcers, or tingling of lips/mouth after eating	☐	☐	☐	☐

#	SYMPTOM	0	1	2	3
8	Joint aches or stiffness without injury	☐	☐	☐	☐
9	Unexplained iron deficiency, anaemia or low vitamin D	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	Irregular cycles, or unexplained fertility difficulty	☐	☐	☐	☐
11	A first-degree relative with celiac disease, IBD or food allergy	☐ (no)			☐ (yes = 3)
12	Symptoms improve when I skip a particular food	☐	☐	☐	☐

Total ____ / **36**. 0–8 = low likelihood of a food driver (look at sleep, stress and sugar first) · 9–18 = keep the diary for a week; a single-food trial may be worthwhile · 19–36 = keep the diary **and** see your doctor before any elimination. Any "yes" on item 7 with swelling or breathing difficulty is an allergy warning: see a doctor urgently and do not self-test.

My suspect food (one only): ☐ gluten (doctor + celiac test first) ☐ dairy ☐ eggs ☐ soy ☐ corn ☐ high-FODMAP foods (with a dietitian) ☐ added sugar ☐ alcohol ☐ caffeine ☐ other: _____

Part 2 · 7-day food & symptom diary (before any elimination)

Write what you ate, and how you felt two hours later and the next morning. Include sleep and stress: many "food" symptoms follow short nights.

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER / SNACKS	SYMPTOMS 2 H LATER	NEXT MORNING	SLEEP (H)	STRESS 1–10
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							

Pattern check: my worst days followed ☐ a specific food ☐ short sleep ☐ high stress ☐ alcohol/sugar ☐ no clear pattern.

Part 3 · Single-food elimination (30 XP)

1. **One food only**, removed completely, for **2–3 weeks**. Keep everything else the same. Keep the diary.
2. Read labels: gluten hides in soy sauce, sauces, oats (unless certified), beer; dairy in whey, casein, many baked goods.
3. **Replace, don't just remove.** Remove dairy → keep calcium (tinned sardines with bones, leafy greens, tofu set with calcium, fortified alternatives). Remove gluten → keep fiber and B vitamins (oats if certified, quinoa, brown rice, beans).
4. Score your symptoms each week (0–3 on the quiz items): week 0 ____ · week 1 ____ · week 2 ____ · week 3 ____.

Part 4 · Reintroduction (the part people skip)

Eat a normal portion of the food once, then watch for **3 days** (some reactions are delayed). No symptoms → it's probably not your problem; enjoy it. Symptoms return → you have an evidence-based answer to take to your doctor or dietitian.

Part 5 · Your doctor conversation (bring this page and the diary)

- "I'm trying to conceive and I've kept a food-symptom diary for a week; here it is."
- "Could we test for celiac disease **before** I change my diet?" (tTG-IgA, total IgA; tests need gluten in the diet)
- "Would you check iron/ferritin, vitamin D, B12 and thyroid?"
- "If I trial removing one food for three weeks, is there anything I should watch for?"
- "Should I see a registered dietitian?"

What we decided: _____

Report in the forum (20 XP)

Post: my suspect food, what the diary showed, and what my doctor advised. No private medical detail needed.

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.